

Data Specification

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FireVigil — AI-Based Detection and Classification of Industrial Fires and Persistent Thermal Sources Using NASA FIRMS, OSM & Satellite Data

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FireVigil — AI-Based Detection and Classification of Industrial Fires and Persistent Thermal Sources Using NASA FIRMS, OSM & Satellite Data

SIH Problem Statement ID	SIH26162
Theme	Disaster Management
Sponsoring Organization	National Technical Research Organisation (NTRO)
Official Dataset Link	firms.modaps.eosdis.nasa.gov/map
Document version	1.0
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1. Purpose

This document specifies every dataset the system consumes or produces: source, access method, refresh cadence, field-level schema, units, and validation rules. It is the single reference for anyone implementing ingestion, the classification service, or the database layer, and for judges/reviewers who want to verify data provenance against the official PS dataset link.

2. External Data Sources

2.1 NASA FIRMS (Fire Information for Resource Management System) — Official Dataset

Official link (as given in PS)	firms.modaps.eosdis.nasa.gov/map
Programmatic access	FIRMS Area/Country API — https://firms.modaps.eosdis.nasa.gov/api/area/csv/{MAP_KEY}/{SOURCE}/{AREA_COORDINATES}/{DAY_RANGE}
Auth	Free MAP_KEY (API key), registered at firms.modaps.eosdis.nasa.gov
Formats available	CSV, JSON, SHP, KML, WMS
Update cadence	Near-real-time (NRT): new data within ~3 hours of satellite overpass, several passes/day per sensor

Coverage used	India bounding box (configurable), full country supported via <code>SOURCE=VIIRS_SNPP_NRT</code> , <code>MODIS_NRT</code> , etc.
Historical archive	Available back to 2000 (MODIS) / 2012 (VIIRS) for baseline/training data

Sensor sources consumed:

Source code	Sensor	Spatial resolution	Notes
<code>MODIS_NRT</code> / <code>MODIS_SP</code>	MODIS (Aqua & Terra)	1 km	Long historical baseline, coarser resolution
<code>VIIRS_SNPP_NRT</code>	VIIRS (Suomi-NPP)	375 m	Primary source — finer resolution, better for small industrial fires
<code>VIIRS_NOAA20_NRT</code>	VIIRS (NOAA-20)	375 m	Additional daily pass
<code>VIIRS_NOAA21_NRT</code>	VIIRS (NOAA-21)	375 m	Additional daily pass

Raw record field schema (CSV/API response):

Field	Type	Unit / Range	Description
<code>latitude</code>	float	−90 to 90	Detection center latitude
<code>longitude</code>	float	−180 to 180	Detection center longitude
<code>bright_ti4</code> / <code>brightness</code>	float	Kelvin	Brightness temperature, I-4/Channel 21/22 (fire-sensitive channel)
<code>bright_ti5</code>	float	Kelvin	Brightness temperature, I-5 (VIIRS only)
<code>scan</code> , <code>track</code>	float	km	Pixel size (along scan/track) — used to estimate detection footprint
<code>acq_date</code>	date	YYYY-MM-DD	Acquisition date
<code>acq_time</code>	string	HHMM (UTC)	Acquisition time
<code>satellite</code>	string	e.g. <code>N</code> , <code>I</code> , <code>T</code> , <code>A</code>	Satellite identifier
<code>instrument</code>	string	<code>MODIS</code> <code>VIIRS</code>	Sensor instrument
<code>confidence</code>	string/int	low / nominal / high (VIIRS) or 0–100 (MODIS)	Detection confidence
<code>version</code>	string	e.g. <code>2.0NRT</code>	Product/collection version
<code>frp</code>	float	MW (megawatts)	Fire Radiative Power — proxy for thermal intensity, key classification feature
<code>daynight</code>	string	<code>D</code> <code>N</code>	Day or night detection
<code>type</code> (MODIS only)	int	0–3	0 = presumed vegetation fire, 1 = active volcano, 2 = other static land source, 3 = offshore

Classification relevance: `frp` , `confidence` , `daynight` , `bright_ti4/ti5` , and detection **recurrence at the same coordinates over time** are the primary engineered features feeding the classifier (see Section 4.3).

2.2 OpenStreetMap (OSM) — Industrial Infrastructure Layer

Access method	Overpass API (<code>https://overpass-api.de/api/interpreter</code>)
Format	OSM XML / GeoJSON (via <code>osmtogeojson</code>)
Refresh cadence	Weekly/on-demand sync (facility locations change slowly)
License	ODbL (Open Database License) — attribution required

Overpass tags queried (mapped to the PS-named facility types):

PS-named facility type	OSM tag(s) queried
Oil refineries	<code>man_made=works</code> + <code>industrial=oil</code> / <code>landuse=industrial</code> + name matching
Petrochemical complexes	<code>industrial=oil</code> / <code>industrial=chemical</code>
Thermal power plants	<code>power=plant</code> + <code>plant:source=coal\ gas\ oil</code>
Steel industries	<code>industrial=iron_and_steel</code> / <code>landuse=industrial</code> + name matching
Mining areas	<code>landuse=quarry</code> , <code>man_made=mineshaft</code> , <code>industrial=mine</code>
LNG terminals	<code>man_made=storage_tank</code> + <code>content=lng</code> , <code>industrial=gas</code>

Facility record schema (post-processing into internal DB):

Field	Type	Description
osm_id	string	Source OSM node/way/relation ID
name	string	Facility name (may be null in OSM — flagged for manual enrichment)
facility_type	enum	refinery petrochemical power_plant steel mining lng_terminal other_industrial
geometry	PostGIS geometry (Point/Polygon)	Facility footprint or centroid
state, district	string	Derived via reverse geocoding against admin boundaries
source	string	osm (extendable to future registries, e.g. CPCB)
last_synced_at	timestamp	Last successful OSM sync time

2.3 Land-Cover Dataset — Industrial vs. Natural Discriminator

Required to satisfy the official deliverable “classification and segregation of industrial fires from forest fires and other natural fires” — land cover at the detection point is a primary discriminating feature.

Candidate sources	ESA WorldCover 10m (2021), Bhuvan/ISRO LULC (national, India-specific), Copernicus Global Land Cover 100m
Format	GeoTIFF raster
Access	Free download (ESA WorldCover via Copernicus/AWS Open Data; Bhuvan via ISRO NRSC portal)
Refresh cadence	Static per release (annual product); re-downloaded on major version updates only

Land-cover classes used for feature engineering:

Class	Relevance
Forest / tree cover	Strong indicator of natural/forest fire when detection falls here and is far from any facility
Cropland	Indicator of agricultural burning
Built-up / industrial	Strong indicator of industrial fire when combined with facility proximity
Bare / sparse vegetation	Indicator of mining activity thermal signature
Grassland / shrubland	Weak indicator, natural fire likely

2.4 Satellite Imagery (Stretch Goal — Visual Confirmation)

Source	Copernicus Data Space Ecosystem — Sentinel-2 (10–20m, optical) and Sentinel-3 SLSTR (thermal)
Access	Sentinel Hub API / openEO, free tier
Format	GeoTIFF / PNG tile, fetched per-event at hotspot coordinates and nearest acquisition date
Usage	Rendered as a thumbnail in the event detail panel for analyst visual confirmation; not used as a primary ML input in the MVP

2.5 Administrative Boundaries

Source	Survey of India / datameet open GeoJSON (state & district boundaries)
Format	GeoJSON
Usage	Region filtering in UI, reverse-geocoding facility/hotspot state / district fields

3. Internal Data Schema (System of Record)

All internal storage in **PostgreSQL 16 + PostGIS**. Geometry columns use SRID 4326 (WGS84).

3.1 users

Column	Type	Constraints
id	UUID	PK

name	text	not null
email	text	unique, not null
password_hash	text	not null
role	enum(admin , analyst , viewer)	default viewer
created_at	timestampz	default now()

3.2 facilities

Column	Type	Constraints
id	UUID	PK
osm_id	text	unique per source
name	text	nullable
facility_type	enum (see §2.2)	not null
geometry	geometry(Point/Polygon, 4326)	not null, GiST-indexed
state	text	
district	text	
source	text	default osm
last_synced_at	timestampz	

3.3 hotspots (raw FIRMS ingestion)

Column	Type	Constraints
id	UUID	PK
latitude	double precision	not null
longitude	double precision	not null
geometry	geometry(Point, 4326)	generated from lat/long, GiST-indexed
acq_date	date	not null
acq_time	text	HHMM UTC
satellite	text	
instrument	enum(MODIS , VIIRS)	not null
confidence	text	raw value from FIRMS
frp	numeric	MW, nullable
bright_ti4	numeric	Kelvin, nullable
daynight	enum(D , N)	
raw_payload	jsonb	full original FIRMS record, for auditability
ingested_at	timestampz	default now()
Constraint	unique(latitude , longitude , acq_date , acq_time , instrument , satellite)	prevents duplicate ingestion

3.4 classified_events

Column	Type	Constraints
id	UUID	PK
hotspot_id	UUID	FK → hotspots, not null
facility_id	UUID	FK → facilities, nullable
primary_class	enum(industrial , natural)	not null — official deliverable #1
sub_class	enum(industrial_fire , gas_flare , agricultural_burning , mining_activity , forest_fire , other_natural)	not null
land_cover_type	enum (see §2.3)	
distance_to_facility_m	numeric	meters, nullable
confidence_score	numeric(0-1)	model output confidence
model_version	text	for reproducibility/audit

is_anomalous	boolean	true if deviates from facility's historical baseline
created_at	timestampz	default now()

3.5 facility_baselines

Column	Type	Description
id	UUID	PK
facility_id	UUID	FK → facilities
avg_daily_detections	numeric	rolling average, detections/day
avg_frp	numeric	rolling average FRP (MW)
std_dev_frp	numeric	for anomaly z-score computation
window_start , window_end	date	baseline computation window (e.g., trailing 90 days)
updated_at	timestampz	

3.6 alerts

Column	Type	Description
id	UUID	PK
classified_event_id	UUID	FK → classified_events
severity	enum(high , medium , low)	derived from class + anomaly flag
status	enum(new , acknowledged , resolved , false_positive)	default new
sent_at	timestampz	
acknowledged_by	UUID	FK → users, nullable

3.7 feedback

Column	Type	Description
id	UUID	PK
classified_event_id	UUID	FK → classified_events
user_id	UUID	FK → users
corrected_label	text	analyst-supplied correction (feeds future retraining)
notes	text	
created_at	timestampz	

4. Data Flow & Processing Rules

4.1 Ingestion cadence

Job	Frequency	Source
FIRMS poll	Every 30-60 minutes	FIRMS Area API
OSM facility sync	Weekly	Overpass API
Land-cover raster refresh	On dataset version release (manual trigger)	WorldCover/Bhuvan
Facility baseline recompute	Nightly	Internal, from hotspots / classified_events

4.2 Deduplication rule

A raw hotspot is considered a duplicate (and skipped) if (latitude, longitude, acq_date, acq_time, instrument, satellite) already exists — coordinates are rounded to 5 decimal places (~1.1 m) before comparison to absorb floating-point noise from repeated FIRMS pulls.

4.3 Feature engineering for classification

Feature	Derived from	Purpose
distance_to_nearest_facility_m	hotspot geometry ↔ facilities.geometry (PostGIS ST_Distance)	Core industrial-attribution signal
facility_type (if matched)	facilities.facility_type	Sector-specific prior (e.g., LNG terminals → higher flare likelihood)

land_cover_class	raster lookup at hotspot lat/long	Core natural-vs-industrial discriminator
recurrence_count_90d	count of prior hotspots within ~500m over trailing 90 days	Distinguishes persistent source (flare/kiln) from one-off fire
frp, bright_ti4/ti5	raw FIRMS fields	Thermal intensity signal
daynight	raw FIRMS field	Some sources (flares) are highly consistent day/night; wildfires vary
z_score_frp	$(\text{frp} - \text{facility_baselines.avg_frp}) / \text{std_dev_frp}$	Anomaly detection — flags fires that exceed a facility's "normal" thermal signature

4.4 Classification decision logic (summary)

- If `land_cover_class = forest/grassland/cropland` **and** `distance_to_nearest_facility_m > threshold` (e.g., 1 km) → `primary_class = natural`, `sub_class = forest_fire` or `agricultural_burning` (by land cover).
- If matched to a facility within threshold **and** `recurrence_count_90d` is high with low `z_score_frp` → `primary_class = industrial`, `sub_class = gas_flare` (persistent, expected).
- If matched to a facility **and** `z_score_frp` is high (anomalous spike) or `recurrence_count_90d` is low (new/rare) → `primary_class = industrial`, `sub_class = industrial_fire`, `is_anomalous = true` → triggers high-severity alert.
- If matched to a mining-tagged facility/land cover → `sub_class = mining_activity`.
- Ambiguous/low-confidence cases are queued for analyst review via the feedback loop (§3.7).

4.5 Data retention

Dataset	Retention
Raw hotspots	Indefinite (partitioned by month for query performance)
classified_events	Indefinite (linked to raw hotspot for audit trail)
raw_payload (jsonb)	Indefinite — preserves original FIRMS record for reproducibility
Satellite imagery thumbnails	12 months rolling (object storage lifecycle rule)

5. Data Quality & Validation Rules

- Reject/flag hotspot records with `confidence = low` **and** no facility match **and** no land-cover data available (insufficient signal to classify reliably) — routed to a `sub_class = unclassified` bucket rather than forced into a guess.
- `latitude / longitude` must fall within the configured area-of-interest bounding box; out-of-range records are dropped at ingestion.
- Facility geometries with `name IS NULL` are retained but flagged `needs_review` for manual name enrichment (OSM data quality varies by region).
- All classification outputs must carry `model_version` for reproducibility and to support before/after comparison when the model is retrained on accumulated `feedback`.

6. Data Provenance & Compliance

- NASA FIRMS:** Data provided by LANCE, part of NASA's Earth Observing System Data and Information System (EOSDIS). Any published output or shared imagery must include the required FIRMS attribution/disclaimer per NASA's data use guidelines.
- OpenStreetMap:** ODbL license — attribution ("© OpenStreetMap contributors") required on all map views.
- Land-cover datasets:** Attribution per source license (ESA WorldCover — CC BY 4.0; Bhuvan — per ISRO/NRSC terms).
- No personally identifiable information (PII) is collected from any external dataset; internal `users` table PII (name, email) is limited to system operators/analysts and is not derived from any external source.